Blanks, zeros and repeats

Data engineering · Level 2 · Lesson 3



Today we will

- Tell a blank from a zero, and never fill one silently.
- Find repeats, after the names agree.
- Check every batch, and keep a cleaning log.

Remember

- A blank is not a zero.
- Clean the names, then look for repeats.
- Checks: in range, not empty, no repeats, known names.

Data detective

1. Warm-up (5 min): Was it a flood?
2. Teach (8 min): Blanks, zeros, repeats and checks.
3. Hunt (15 min): Find the four problems.
4. Recalculate (7 min): Before and after.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): What would no check catch?

Hide the four problems in different stations and days. Keep a copy of the answers, and accept any decision a group can explain and has written in its log.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is a blank mark not the same as a zero?
2. What did stopping the whole batch cost us?
3. What should a cleaning log say?

Exit ticket

- Write one blank, one zero and one repeat you might find in a register, and what you'd do with each.